

Traffic lights for music search

The PRS for music society wants search engines to distinctly identify legal and illegal music download sites with red and green flags

Gaming Laptops

ASUS	Alienware
G74SX	M17x
1,24,990	1,59,000
1 year	1 year
Superb build, good performance	Superb looking, fast
Large and bulky, expensive	Expensive, very bulky
70.14	66.76
12.58	14.96
9.35	10.10
48.21	41.70

Intel Core i7-2630QM	Intel Core i7 2630QM
2000	2000
16384 / DDR3 / 1333	8192 / DDR3 / 1333
NVIDIA GeForce GTX 560M	NVIDIA GeForce GT460M
Y / 3072	Y / 1536
1TB	2 x 750GB
Blu-ray drive / 2X	Bluray / DVD RW combo
Windows 7 Ultimate	Windows 7 Ultimate
Y	Y

17.1 / 1920 x 1080	17.3 / 1920 x 1080
4.28	4.3 Kg
4/None	4 / None
Y/Y/Y	Y/Y/Y
N	Y
Y/N/Y/N	Y/N/Y/Y

9 / 7.5 / 8.75	8.75 / 7.5 / 8.5
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7.25 / 7.5	7.5 / 8
6	7
7.25 / 6.5	7.25 / 6.75
N / N / N	Y / N / N

6950	9043
10020	8015
1673 / 6277 / 1689	1364 / 6264 / 1457
28.1 / 7.6 / 61.1	24.18 / 8.1 / 53.3
709	628
4.49 / 40.42	5.24 / 42.61

115	70
7.5	8
45.01 / 37.23	38.86 / 31.93

46.15	40.4
67.84 / 108.72	60.48 / 102.6
45.2	40.2
72.3 / 95.8	63.4 / 86.3
22.64	12.55
22.76 / 59.44	12.58 / 34.65

We received a price of ₹64,900 for the M11x that would make it a superb deal. Unfortunately, this price is for the base version and we got a heavier configuration. The Dell India web site doesn't allow any configuration, but the model we received should be in excess of ₹80,000. Not recommended for hardcore gamers.

MSI GX660: ₹79,999

The MSI GX660 is a little overdone in the looks department. In fact we'd go as far as calling it unappealing, for the design is a little confusing. The lid is plasticity – a mile away from the brushed metal finish on the MSI GT780R. The palmrest feels well built. It has a neat row of backlit touch controls embedded within a transparent bezel on top of the keypad, but the garish orange back-lighting isn't as soothing as we'd like. Bluetooth, eco and high power modes and a customisable control are just some of the controls available, aside from a couple of multimedia buttons. Overall, we can't fault the build quality of the GX660 although the materials seem more inclined towards being glossy, and this itself gives the impression of being less upmarket than the matte finishes that Alienware or ASUS impart their notebooks. The GX660 has a nicely spaced out keypad, although this doesn't make it a great one. We feel the keys are a little small, and the cheaper GE620 had better, spongy and softer keys.

The GX660 features the mobile version of the mighty AMD Radeon HD 5870 graphics card, the Radeon 5870M, and this itself puts

it in a league above the other two notebooks costing less than a lakh. In fact, the HD 5870M propels it beyond the other notebooks. During the benchmarks, it became clear that AMD's previous generation (Radeon 5xxx series) fizzled out, as the physics score in 3D Mark 11 shows. At 2684, it's much lower than the 6092 points scored by the MSI GX780R. However, a score of 40.24 fps in *Dirt 3*, at maximum settings, with multi-sample anti-aliasing enabled is impressive, as is 59.3 fps in *S.T.A.L.K.E.R Call Of Pripyat* at native resolution and max settings.

Although well built, the GX660 looks a little overdone. However, this doesn't stand in the way



MSI GX660

of its performance. For ₹79,999, the GX660 is a good option for those looking at a powerful notebook under a lakh. It will play all the current generation games with ease, although you might need to be a bit frugal on the eye candy. It won our Digit Best Buy pick for the sub-1 lakh category.

NOTEBOOKS OVER A LAKH

Flashing lights, embedded LEDs, faster graphic cards and

fancier surface finishes – you can expect all these things from the top-tier gaming notebooks. We have four beauties for you – two from MSI, and one each from ASUS and Alienware.

MSI GX780R: ₹1,19,999

The GX780R is MSI's latest offering and its top-of-the-line gaming series notebook. And it looks the part – large and handsome. It's quite a thick notebook, more so at the lid portion and then it slims out towards the front, giving the impression of a forward sloping design that looks aggressive. The plastic is distinctly more upmarket than on the cheaper-looking GX660. The lid is inset with brushed metal. The palm rest also has a brushed metal finish, and the plastic surrounding the keypad feels better than the GX660 and GT680R. The speaker grilles are placed above the keypad to either side of it and unlike the GX660 and GT680R that have distinctly round grilles, these are rectangular. While the lid seems good quality, one can't compare its

mechanism to the Alienware notebooks that are in a league of their own.

Once again, MSI has chosen an isolated keypad design and the GX780R has nicely spaced keys that feel a little better compared to the GX660. It doesn't have the backlit indicators around the trackpad like the GX660, but looks more suave and subtle for it. This was the first gaming notebook we came across that had a massive 16 GB of RAM. The Core i7 2630QM and NVIDIA GeForce GT555M are more mundane, but equally impressive, although, (given its pricing) we were secretly hoping for a more powerful